

MeitY unveils pilot project on electronics repair services outsourcing

With the vision to make India a global electronics powerhouse, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) recently launched the ERSO pilot initiative. It was aimed to validate certain transformational policy and process changes to make India the “Repair Capital of the World,” as mentioned by the government in a statement. It will enable the extension of device life globally by providing cheap and reliable repair of ICT products for the whole world. The pilot is being held in Bengaluru and will be running for a period of three months. The press release noted that the ERSO initiative supports Mission LiFE and will be a game-changer for global environmental sustainability.

Government invites applications for setting up semicon and display fabs

For the development of the semiconductor and display manufacturing ecosystem in India, the Central government has decided to invite applications for setting up semiconductor and display fabs in India. The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) announced that applications for setting up semiconductor and display fabs as per Modified Semicon India Programme are invited. India Semiconductor Mission, which is the designated nodal agency entrusted with the responsibility of implementing the Modified Semicon India Programme, will receive these applications. All applicants who had applied under the old, separate schemes for setting up of semiconductor fabs and display fabs were allowed to submit applications under the modified schemes after incorporating suitable modifications in their proposals.

Government considering import duty reduction on solar panels

As per a recent report from Reuters, the Indian Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) is mulling

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events		
Event, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
IFA Berlin 2023 September 1-5, 2023 Messe Berlin Exhibition Grounds Berlin, Germany	The mega consumer electronics and home appliances trade show IFA is a great meeting place for key retailers, buyers, and experts from the industry and the media. It showcases exhibitors' brands to a global audience, generates qualified leads, and strengthens existing relationships. IFA Berlin offers discounted voucher codes to trade visitors!	Website: https://www.electronicsexpo.com/events/ifa-berlin-2023 , www.indo-german.com
Open Source India 2023 NIMHANS Convention Center, Bengaluru October 12-13, 2023	Open Source For You magazine, in partnership with India's Open Source community and industry, brings various stakeholders under one roof to accelerate development and deployment of open source in India, and beyond.	Website: https://www.opensourceindia.in
Productronica 2023 November 14-17, 2023 Munich, Germany	World's leading trade fair for electronics development and production. Companies from the fields of PCB & EMS, SMT, semiconductors, inspection and quality, future production and smart factory, and cables, coils and hybrids will present their solutions and products.	Website: https://productronica.com
India Electronics Week KTPO, Whitefield Bengaluru February 7-9, 2024	India's No. 1 event for creators of smart electronics solutions to discover latest techniques, best practices and technologies for developing electronics better, cheaper and faster, and meet service providers, suppliers and partners who can enable growth of your business.	Website: www.indiaelectronicsweek.com
IoTShow.in 2024 KTPO, Whitefield Bengaluru February 7-9, 2024	The conferences and hands-on workshops, cutting-edge talks and trainings by industry stalwarts and thought leaders will help build the skills you need to get ahead in the field.	Website: https://www.iotshow.in
Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.		

over the idea to cut the import tax on solar panels from 40% to 20%. MNRE officials recently held talks with the finance ministry to approve its request, claims the report. Furthermore, in response to the increasing demand for renewable energy and a shortage in domestic output, the government is looking for a reduction in Goods and Services Taxes (GST) on renewable energy devices. The report anticipated that the two ministries may make a recommendation to India's Good and Services Tax (GST) Council to lower the GST on solar panels to 5% from the 12% imposed in 2021.

Government approves another major revival package for BSNL

The Indian government approved a revival package of ₹890.47 billion for state-run telecom operator Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) on 7th June. This is the third revival package for BSNL that includes the allotment of the 4G/5G spectrum through an equity infusion. BSNL's losses fell to ₹69.82 billion in the year ended March 2022 from ₹74.41 billion a year ago. “With this revival package, BSNL will emerge as a stable telecom service provider focused on providing connectivity to the remotest parts of India,” the cabinet said in a statement.

TSSC and Britco & Bridco to unveil CoE for mobile repair in Kerala

India's leading skill development institution Telcom Sector Skill Council (TSSC) recently announced its strategic partnership with Britco & Bridco, a skill-based organisation, to open a “state-of-the-art Mega Centre of Excellence” (CoE) to train youth in mobile handset repair courses in Kerala. As per the press release, the CoE will serve as a hub for comprehensive training programmes in mobile handset repair. Under the partnership, TSSC will train about 3,500 youth candidates in the next year and help in placing them internationally and also empower them to become entrepreneurs. The parties are trying to give a major push to the ‘Right to Repair’ initiative, which seeks to give consumers and independent repair professionals access to the necessary tools, documentation, and parts needed to repair electronic devices.

HPCL Mittal to source 250MW renewable energy from NTPC Green

Recently, NTPC Green Energy Limited (NGEL) and HPCL Mittal Energy Limited (HMEL) signed an MoU to move ahead in the domain of green energy and realise their energy transi-